Task ‘Collaborative Discussion Summary Code of Ethics and Professional Conduct’ Unit 1

Peer Response 2

Hi Lana,

I agree with your argument that the main issue in the AllTogether case was not simply a failure to identify accessibility problems, but the decision by leadership to release the software despite knowing about them. I particularly agree with your point that the number of disabled users should never determine whether accessibility is prioritized. As you highlighted, low usage does not necessarily mean low demand, since inaccessible design may prevent people from using a product in the first place.

(ACM., n.d.; Menezes-Fidelis., 2026)

Also, your post brings up an important difference between ethical responsibility and legal compliance. Even when a company documents accessibility issues and provides alternative support, this does not remove the barriers experienced by disabled users. I think this is particularly relevant to ACM Principle 1.2, as avoiding harm requires preventing foreseeable problems rather than simply responding after users have been affected.

(ACM., 2018)

I find your argument of McNamara, interesting as it highlights that having professional codes of ethics is not enough if organizations do not translate those principles into everyday decisions.

(McNamara et al., 2018)

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In this case, AllTogether already had an accessibility policy, a Diversity Advisory Board and established guidelines, yet leadership still prioritized the release schedule.

(ACM., n.d.)

Also here, I fully agree with your strong argument that ethical responsibility must be supported by organizational accountability and the authority to delay releases when critical accessibility requirements are not met.

One additional point is that involving people with disabilities throughout the development and testing process could have prevented many of these problems. Rather than relying exclusively on internal QA testing, the company could have gathered feedback from users with different accessibility needs before finalizing the feature.

(Šumak., 2023)

Overall, I agree with your suggestion that accessible functionality should be validated before release. A company's commitment to accessibility should be demonstrated through its decisions and actions, not simply through its policies and statements.

(**********., 2026)

Reference

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